

OpenSolaris on Xen **Part 2**

Exploring a

dom0

OpenSolaris

Let's play around with a dom0 OpenSolaris to understand it better.

In this article we'll use the latest version of OpenSolaris (version 2009.06) to set up Xen. Refer to '*Solaris For Your Desktop*', published in the April 2009 issue of LFY, if you need installation instructions. Additionally, since version 2009.06 doesn't come with the Xen packages installed and we need these to be able to boot the system as Xen dom0, follow the instructions given at http://opensolaris.org/os/community/xen/docs/2008_11_dom0 to achieve the same.

Upon reboot, pick up the 'xvm' Grub entry to boot into Xen. Once it comes up, log in as the user you configured while installing os2009.06. To make sure that this guest is running on the Xen hypervisor, follow the steps below:

```
surya@opensolaris:~$ uname -i
i86xpv
surya@opensolaris:~$
```

If `uname -i` reports `i86xpv`, then it is a PV guest. What does it report on bare metal? To confirm that this is a privileged domain (i.e., dom0), run the following:

```
surya@opensolaris:~$ pfexec cat /dev/xen/domcaps
control_d
surya@opensolaris:~$
```

This confirms it is a '*control domain*'. For any other domU, it will be empty.

To get a feel of how 'thin' the hypervisor is, look at the hypercalls listed in `/usr/include/xen/xen.h`—they add up to less than